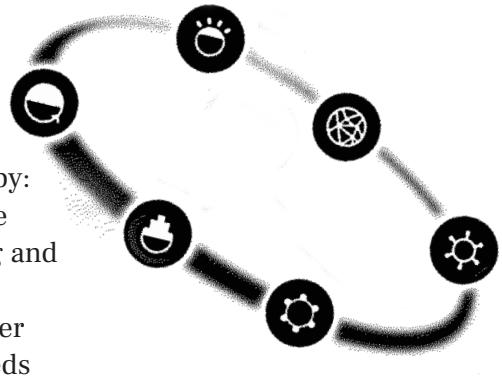
A POLICY VISION FOR EARTH OBSERVATION

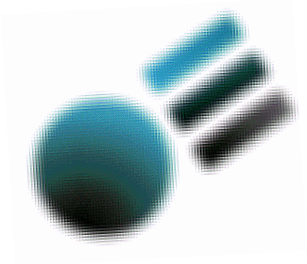
FOOD, WATER, ENERGY, DEMOCRACY, PEACE EMPOWERED THROUGH SPACE



A CALL TO POLICYMAKERS

To strengthen Europe's ability to use space in support of its strategic goals by:

- Embedding space-based solutions in key policy areas, from climate and energy to security and diplomacy, to improve decision-making and implementation
- Guiding and supporting the Earth Observation community to deliver more tailored, scalable, and user-driven solutions for Europe's needs



A VISION FOR EARTH OBSERVATION

Scientific excellence and technological innovation in Earth Observation must go hand in hand with clear policy guidance to:

- Align capability development with policy needs, ensuring that investments respond to real-world priorities
- Boost the integration of space-based insights into policymaking
- Enable smarter policymaking, turning capabilities into policy impact

> ***"The efforts to involve the wider policy community with Earth Observation show a broad range of potential uses of space and create valuable new connections with and within the policy community."*** – Lord David Willetts

A TASK OF A DECADE

Embedding Earth Observation across the full policy cycle to:

- Make policymaking more efficient, effective and accountable
- Maximise the benefits of space for the economy, society and the environment
- Build strategic advantage and boost resilience in the face of global challenges

This Vision, developed by ESPI also leveraging the expertise and support of ESA, is informed by a workshop held at the Royal Society in April 2025, involving policymakers, space actors and sector experts

"Earth Observation is a key strategic tool for policy implementation and must be integrated into a long-term policy vision."
– Simonetta Cheli

Reversing Europe's biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation

Boosting production and profitability of a water-smart agrifood sector

FOOD

ENERGY

Securing energy, communications and trade infrastructures in the Arctic & Baltic

EARTH OBSERVATION SUPPORTS POLICYMAKING IN HIGH-PRIORITY DOMAINS ACROSS THE WHOLE POLICY CYCLE, FROM AGENDA SETTING TO IMPLEMENTATION AND REVIEW OF POLICIES.

WATER

PEACE

Tackling water scarcity and reservoir depletion

Reconstructing Ukraine towards a state-of-the-art & sustainable infrastructure

DEMOCRACY

Strengthening Europe's diplomatic action through development cooperation

Enabling cheaper, effective & resilient urban planning

The Vision paper outlines these and further opportunities for using Earth Observation.
It also provides examples and instruments to familiarise with the use of space in priority domains.

Download the digital copy of the Vision paper

Contribute to bringing this Vision to life.
Be a catalyst in your community

Get in touch with ESPI